Candlestick with copper candle cup

Colwin Way makes a charming oak candlestick

PHOTOGRAPHS BY COLWIN WAY

COLWIN WAY

Colwin started turning aged 13 and has since gone on to teach the craft and wishes to continue to give people confidence to try the wonderful hobby for themselves. Colwin was born and grew up in Lyme Regis, a small seaside town in the southwest of England, and is still living in the area with his wife Vicki and two sons, Finley and Charlie.

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This is probably one of my favourite projects in turning, because it's all about the design and balance of the piece. It doesn't really matter what the timber is either, to the point you could use an old gate post and still have a really nicely finished project. You could also experiment with finishing techniques like colouring, bleaching, polishing and texturing.

The candlestick can either be made as a pair or an individual, large or small. I would always consider drawing the design out first and even sourcing images to help with your design, from books and the internet. Once you've come up with a design, think about the candle to use in your candlestick to make sure it fits in with the shape you've turned. I don't like my designs being limited to pre-bought candle cup holders either, so I make my own from brass and copper sheet either by spinning or planishing.

I'm going to make this candlestick out of some old re-claimed oak (*Quercus robur*) I had left over in the workshop from a previous project and for the candle holder itself, I'm going do some basic metal spinning to form a copper dish.

To prepare the blank for turning I needed to glue together my plank offcuts and instead of starting with a size in mind, I made the largest blank I could get out of the pieces I had and, in this case, that gave me a blank measuring 440 x 120mm.

Any good wood glue is fine to use. This is a step that needs to be taken seriously and extra attention is needed to get a good joint. Make sure your glue is appropriate for the job in hand and is in date! Remember the blank will be turning at several hundred revolutions a minute; to have a joint fail at this speed could lead to serious injury.

One extra precaution I took before I mounted the blank on the lathe was to take the corners off with my bandsaw. This helps to reduce impact when I start to rough the blank down, so I can start at a slightly higher speed with the tool rest closer to the timber.

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